PROPERTY FINDER · PRODUCT BUILDER CHALLENGE

Trust Assistant: a short list you can believe

Prototype ↗ Repo ↗ Audit (Excel) ↗ Rules ↗ Probable bug ↗

Persona

Divyanshi, short-term renter
India → Dubai, first time

"Show me a studio I'd actually like, at the price I'll really pay."

Needs

- Studio with a real kitchen; monthly terms
- All-in ≤ AED 7,500/mo, approved by her company
- Safe building, metro or easy cabs
- Finalise from India, on her phone

Frustrations

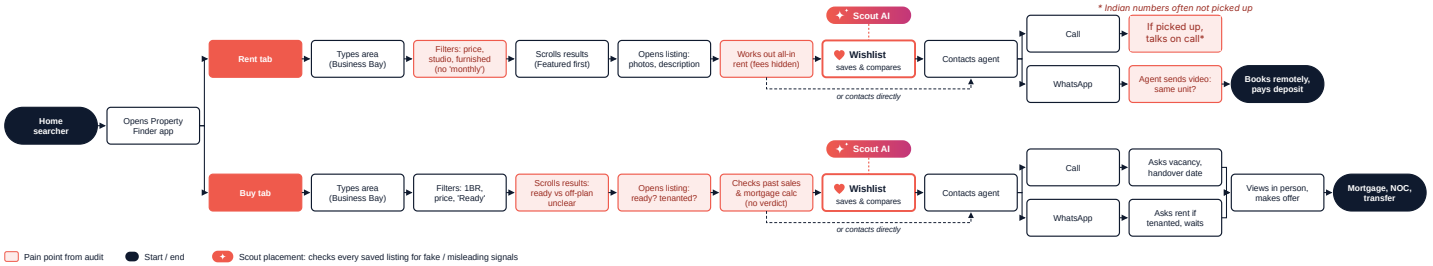
- Hidden fees broke an approved budget
- Bait photos; a different unit on WhatsApp
- Re-explains needs; agents ignore Indian numbers
- Only ~10 of 30 WhatsApps got a reply (my past search)
- Loses track across ~10 WhatsApp chats

Stakeholders

1. **Searcher** — Renter or buyer seeking a real home
2. **Agent / Agency** — Posts listings, earns from leads
3. **Property Owner** — Landlord or seller wanting a fair price
4. **Property Finder** — Balances agent revenue with searcher trust
5. **Holiday-Home Operators** — Short-stay units with hotel-style fees
6. **Developers** — Sell off-plan using renders and "from" prices

** I studied the renter's flow in depth; the buyer's flow only at a bird's-eye level, within this assignment's scope.*

User journey



The problem behind the problem

On the surface: some listings are fake. **Underneath:** from the page she can't tell which listings are real, available and within budget. So she messages everyone, waits, and gives up; honest listings get buried under bait; and PF never learns which listings misled her, because the truth comes out later on WhatsApp.
Audit, 32 live studios (Excel · repo): only 2/30 raise no warning sign · 0/30 let you work out the all-in price · 16/30 listed 90+ days ago · only 12/32 were worth an inquiry.

Rules · full set ↗

Each warning sign lowers trust. Scout sorts saved homes into **Looks genuine** · **Needs checking** · **Likely misleading**, and always says why.

R1	No permit, or fake licence	R2	"Studio" is really a hotel room
R3	Two or more warning signs	R4	Listed 90+ days: still free?
R5	Price ±20% vs area median	R6	Same unit, 2 agents, same price
R7	Photos or size don't match	R8	Hidden fees or conditional price
R9	Building or location unclear	R10	Buyer: handover, tenancy unclear

Where rules break: each rule in RULES.md lists a real case where it's wrong, e.g. R6 thinks #16/#17 are one unit; they're on different floors. Tested on my 32 calls: 14/32 → 31/32.

Where it lives

In the **Wishlist**, on web and app: the ♥ is the trigger. Scout checks every saved home ("Scout checked your 32 saved homes: 8 look misleading"); each card shows **Looks genuine**, **Needs checking** or **Likely misleading** with a one-line reason. "Ask Scout to verify" drafts one message per agent; nothing is sent until she taps Send. Not on search results (I couldn't reach Scout): verdicts stay private, no public badge.

Why use it, and when not

Use it to find out: which listings are real, which agents are likely to reply, which listings are misleading, and which really fit the budget once the fees hidden in the description are added. **Don't:** when you already trust the agent, for viewings, negotiation or signing (it hands over to a human), or for legal or mortgage decisions.

Agents and PF revenue (a suggestion)

No data yet on the revenue impact, so this is the trade-off if PF ships it.
Pros: honest agents get serious leads and credit for stating fees; bait listings lose leads; verdicts stay private, so no public label hits paying agents; a trust edge over Bayut's TruCheck; PF learns which listings mislead. **Cons:** fewer raw leads at first, while PF earns per listing and lead; false flags can hurt honest agents (holiday homes look stale); agent pushback.

Metrics it moves

Portal metrics: searcher-to-lead rate, agent reply rate, lead-to-viewing/deal rate, returning searchers, agent spend.
What Scout should move, from the 32-listing audit: fewer messages wasted on poor listings (only 12/32 were worth one), a higher agent reply rate (~10/30 in my search), and a faster route to a trusted short list. The size of each move needs the 1% test.

One number that proves it: how often Scout is right. Of the homes Scout calls Looks genuine, what share does the agent confirm are real, still free and at that price? **Test:** turn Scout on for 1% of renters in Business Bay and Marina for 4 weeks, and compare with the other 99%. **I'm wrong if** Scout's homes aren't confirmed at least 5 points more often, or people don't book more viewings.

What I could not build (priority order)

Feature	Why it's needed	Why I couldn't add it
1. Real agent replies	Real replies and reply rates (simulated / sample in the UI)	No WhatsApp or PF inbox integration; no reply data
2. Buyer-side prototype	The assistant must work for buyers too	Time; buyer research was bird's-eye only (8 listings, no interviews)
3. Live permit and licence check	R1: proves who the advertiser is	No DLD Trakheesi / DTCM data access
4. Photo matching across listings	R7: catches recycled bait photo sets	Needs PF's image store plus engineering
5. DLD transaction prices	R5: fair price per building, esp. for buyers	No DLD feed; used listing medians instead
6. Outcome feedback loop	Contradicted listings reported to PF moderation	Needs PF backend and a moderation process
7. LLM reading of descriptions	Extracts fees and terms from free text	No API key; prototype uses fixed rules